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Netaji's First Broadcast over the Azad Hind Radio

[The following is the text of Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose's first broadcast to the world over the Azad Hind Radio on February 19, 1942.—Ed.]

THIS is Subhas Chandra Bose speaking to you over the Azad Hind Radio.

For about a year I have waited in silence and patience for the march of events and now that the hour has struck, I come forward to speak.

The fall of Singapore means the collapse of the British Empire, the end of the iniquitous regime which it has symbolised and the dawn of a new era in Indian history. The Indian people who have long suffered from the humiliation of a foreign yoke and have been ruined spiritually, culturally, politically and economically while under British domination—must now offer their humble thanks to the Almighty for the auspicious event which bears for India the promise of life and freedom.

British Imperialism has in modern history been the most diabolical enemy of freedom and the most formidable obstacle to progress. Because of it, a very large section of mankind has been kept enslaved and in India alone, about one-fifth of the human race has been ruthlessly suppressed and persecuted. For other nations, British Imperialism may be the enemy of today, but for India, it is the eternal foe. Between these two there can be neither peace nor compromise. And the enemies of British Imperialism are the natural allies of India—just as the allies of British Imperialism are today our natural enemies.

The outside world hears from time to time voices coming from India, claiming to speak either in the name of the Indian National Congress or of the Indian people. But these are voices coming